



SK HYNIX

OUTPERFORM

PRICE* KRW1,226,000 ■ TARGET PRICE **KRW2,000,000** (UPSIDE 63%)

TARGET PRICE	EPS 26e	EPS 27e
↗ 26%	↗ 56%	↗ 25%

Enhanced AI memory leadership; less concern on oversupply

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SKH reported robust 1Q results, mainly driven by mid-60%/mid-70% DRAM/NAND ASP surge. Despite recent weakness in memory spot prices, we think contract prices will continue to move up in the following quarters, given the on-going supply tightness. We raise TP to KRW2,000,000 (still based on 3x 2027E BVPS), mainly on higher shipment and ASP assumptions.

Balanced AI-memory exposure

HBM contribution to DRAM rev. fell to c25% in 1Q26 (2025: c40%), likely on faster price hikes for non-HBM memory, and SKH's balanced capacity allocation strategy. HBM should remain the focus and solidify SKH's leadership in AI memory. We expect SKH to gain >50% share in the upcoming HBM4E (target sampling in 2H26 and mass production in 2027), by offering superior and more tailored solutions via its cooperation with TSMC on base-die tech and SKH's 1cnm DRAM-die tech.

No concern about memory optimisation technology

We believe the memory-optimisation technologies aim for higher economics of memory investment and AI services, ultimately expanding memory TAM rather than reducing memory usage. Despite Google's TurboQuant tech, its newly introduced TPU 8t and 8i still increase HBM3E capacity to 216GB and 288GB respectively, from 192GB in Ironwood. That said, we think memory-optimisation technologies would increase AI customers' affordability of high memory prices.

Manage disciplined capacity expansion

SKH aims to complete the cleanroom of Yongin Cluster Phase 1 in Feb-2027, 3 months ahead of plan, while the construction pace of Phases 2-6 will depend on memory-market conditions. We think SKH prefers flexibility on capacity expansion, considering the mid-/long-term demand visibility and optimised LTA terms. On NAND, we expect near-term bit-shipment growth to be mainly led by tech upgrades to 321L NAND (from 176L), taking c50% of SKH's domestic (or 30% global) NAND production by end-2026 vs our prev. estimate of c40% penetration level of >2xx-3xxL by 2026.

SK Hynix (+)

000660 KS

*Closing Price (22 April 2026)	KRW1,226,000			
Volume (KRWm / EURm)	NC / NC			
Market cap (KRWbn / EURbn)	848,091.9 / 490.3			
Free float (KRWbn / EURbn)	568,221.6 / 328.5			
EV (KRWbn / EURbn)	699,137.3 / 404.2			
Country / Sub Sector	Korea / Semiconductors			

Financials	12/25	12/26e	12/27e	12/28e
EPS, Adjusted (KRW)	60,402.9	256,037.8	235,213.8	210,351.5
EPS, Company (KRW)	61,984	263,260	241,848	216,285
EPS - Bloomberg (KRW)	57,228.6	235,592.4	309,091.4	332,876.6
Net dividend (KRW)	3,000.0	8,814.2	8,097.3	7,241.4
Sales (KRWbn)	97,147	281,119	288,082	272,664
EBITA, Adj. (KRWbn)	47,206	211,335	199,806	172,820
Net profit, Adj. (KRWbn)	42,919	182,111	167,300	149,616
ROCE (%)	35.7	112.1	95.6	74.0
Net Debt/EBITDA, Adj. (x)	0.1	-	-	-

Source: BNP Paribas Equity Research (estimates), Bloomberg (consensus) (1) In listing currency, with dividend reinvested (2) Yearly average price for FY ended 12/25

Performance ⁽¹⁾	1w	1m	3m	12m
Absolute(%)	8	22	62	609
Rel. IT Hardware(%)	5	6	43	230
Rel. MSCI AC APAC(%)	6	15	51	369

Valuation metrics ⁽²⁾	12/25	12/26e	12/27e	12/28e
P/E (x)	5.1	4.8	5.2	5.8
Net yield (%)	1.0	0.7	0.7	0.6
FCF yield (%)	10.5	16.4	15.8	12.3
EV/Sales (x)	2.2	2.5	1.9	1.6
EV/EBITDA (x)	3.5	3.0	2.5	2.2
EV/EBITA (x)	4.5	3.3	2.8	2.5
EV/CE (x)	1.9	4.7	3.3	2.3

All valuation metrics based on adjusted figures

See page 7 for Analyst Certification, Important Disclosures, Non-US Research Analyst disclosures and BNP Paribas Group Corporate Social Responsibility ("CSR") policies. BNP Paribas has adopted strict CSR policies that govern financing and investment in certain sectors. For time of dissemination, please refer to the Cube. *Closing Price (22 April 2026).

Key takeaways from SK Hynix 1Q26 results briefing

1Q26 snapshot: 1Q revenue reached an all-time quarterly high of KRW52.6tr, up by 60% q-q and 198% y-y. Operating profit surged to KRW37.6, nearly doubling q-q. Operating profit margin improved significantly to c72%. The company achieved a net cash position of KRW35tr and reduced its debt-to-equity ratio to 12%.

- Prices for both DRAM and NAND rose meaningfully. ASP rose by mid-60% for DRAM as the strength in conventional DRAM pricing accelerated; NAND ASP rose by mid-70%, supported by strong pricing in all product lines.

- Shipments: DRAM shipments were flat q-q and in line with previous guidance; NAND shipments declined 10% q-q due to a high base and reduced discrete product sales and longer lead times from a larger mix of high-value products.

Outlook: The management highlighted that memory is transitioning from a simple storage component to a core computational pillar for AI.

- Demand: Beyond HBM, demand is expanding into high-density server modules and enterprise SSDs as AI workloads move from training to real-time inference and agent-based tasks.

- Supply remains constrained. Customers are currently prioritising volume over pricing to secure supply, leading to a favourable pricing environment for SK Hynix that is expected to last longer than in previous cycles.

- PC and mobile markets show signs of softening due to cost pressures. However, robust server demand continues to drive overall growth.

- Guidance: SK Hynix will actively respond to demand for high-density server modules and mobile products, with DRAM shipments expected to increase by high-single digit q-q, and NAND to increase by mid-10% q-q through expanded sales of 321-layer-based products and SSDs.

- HBM4 & HBM4E: SK Hynix is aggressively pushing its technological boundaries to maintain its lead in AI memory. SK Hynix's close collaboration with major customers for the two products is underway. HBM4 is ramping up according to customer schedules. HBM4E samples are expected in 2H26, targeting mass production in 2027.

- 1c nm node: mass production of 1c began in late 2025. Both yield and mass production capabilities have already reached a mature stage, helping SK Hynix to supply HBM4E to customers with stable performance and volume. Mass production for 192GB SOCAMM2 based on 1c nm LPDDR5X will begin in April 2026, promising more than twice the bandwidth and 75%+ improved energy efficiency over existing RDIMM and thus making it optimal for higher performance AI computing

- NAND is no longer a simple storage device but a core component that determines computational speed and efficiency, and it's also projected for long-term growth. SK Hynix developed the world's first 321-layer TLC NAND and completed customer qualification in April 2026. To maximise production speed, SK Hynix plans to migrate 50% of domestic production to 321-layer technology by the end of 2026.

Capex: to meet structural demand, capex will increase significantly y-y, with majority allocation to prepare the Yongin Cluster, ramp up of M15X and procurement of key equipment. Construction of the Yongin Cluster is on schedule. The schedule for opening of Phase 1 cleanroom has been preponed by three months to February 2027 from May 2027.

Shareholder return & ADR progress: SK Hynix aims to reach KRW100tr in net cash to ensure stable investments through any market cycle. Beyond dividends, SKH is reviewing share buybacks and cancellations. SKH aims to announce a decision on this within the year. Registration documents have been submitted to the US SEC for a proposed ADR offering, with the goal of listing within 2026.

Impact of Middle-East geopolitical conflict on SKH's supply chain: the management confirmed that suppliers for critical materials (Helium, Bromine, Tungsten) have been diversified, and sufficient inventory has been secured to mitigate geopolitical risks. LNG for power generation is secured through long-term agreements to minimise price volatility.

We raise TP to KRW2,000,000

We raise SK Hynix EPS forecasts by 56%/ 25%/ 14% for 2026/2027/2028 on higher revenue derived from 1) the continuous rise in memory prices – we lift 2026/2027/2028 ASP forecasts by 32%/17%/9% for DRAM and 30%/11%/0% for NAND; 2) stable single-digit shipment growth for both DRAM and NAND, amid ongoing supply shortages cause by strong AI demand. Also, with the expectation that higher-value products will account for a larger portion of the product mix, we increase our 2026-28 GPM assumptions by high single bps.

We arrive at our new TP of KRW2,000,000, based on 3x 2027E BVPS (unchanged). We derive our target P/B multiple by using 2027E ROE of 44% and cost of equity of 14.7% (on stock beta of 2.0x, risk-free rate of 3.7% and equity risk premium 5.5%). Our TP is 26% higher on 26% higher 2027E BVPS, driven by our significantly higher EPS forecasts for 2026 and 2027.

Figure 1: Forecast revisions

KRW BN	2026E		2027E		2028E		2026E	2027E	2028E
	Old	New	Old	New	Old	New			
DRAM shipment (mn GB)	13,903	14,415	16,515	17,349	19,012	19,972	4%	5%	5%
NAND shipment (mn GB)	237,000	252,249	275,631	297,487	319,919	345,287	6%	8%	8%
DRAM ASP (KRW/GB)	11,517	15,224	11,122	12,968	9,701	10,619	32%	17%	9%
NAND ASP (KRW/GB)	182	236	185	205	168	169	30%	11%	0%
Revenue	205,196	281,119	236,781	288,082	240,466	272,664	37%	22%	13%
Gross Profit	150,101	232,270	167,929	223,221	160,511	198,290	55%	33%	24%
GPM %	73%	83%	71%	77%	67%	73%	9.5%	6.6%	6.0%
Net Profit	117,008	182,111	134,053	167,300	130,874	149,616	56%	25%	14%
NPM %	57.0%	64.8%	56.6%	58.1%	54.4%	54.9%	7.8%	1.5%	0.4%

Source: BNP Paribas Equity Research estimates

Figure 2: Financial summary

KRW BN	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	2023	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
Revenue	17,639	22,232	24,449	32,827	52,576	32,766	66,193	97,147	281,119	288,082	272,664
Operating Income (Loss)	7,441	9,213	11,383	19,170	37,610	(7,730)	23,467	47,206	211,335	199,806	172,820
EBITDA	10,774	12,656	14,933	22,733	41,530	5,889	36,012	61,136	229,578	223,773	201,385
Pretax Income	9,299	8,723	14,790	17,653	51,617	(11,658)	23,885	50,466	228,932	209,229	187,114
Net Income for Common Equity	8,107	6,997	12,595	15,220	40,330	(9,112)	19,789	42,919	182,111	167,300	149,616
Basic EPS, GAAP	11,756	10,135	18,242	21,851	57,206	(13,239)	28,727	61,984	263,260	241,848	216,285
Diluted EPS, GAAP	11,405	9,835	17,702	21,395	56,643	(13,239)	28,300	60,337	256,038	235,214	210,351
GPM%	57.3%	53.9%	57.4%	68.8%	79.3%	-1.6%	48.1%	60.4%	82.6%	77.5%	72.7%
EBIT margin%	42.2%	41.4%	46.6%	58.4%	71.5%	-23.6%	35.5%	48.6%	75.2%	69.4%	63.4%
EBITDA margin%	61.1%	56.9%	61.1%	69.3%	79.0%	18.0%	54.4%	62.9%	81.7%	77.7%	73.9%
Net margin%	46.0%	31.5%	51.5%	46.4%	76.7%	-27.8%	29.9%	44.2%	64.8%	58.1%	54.9%
Rev yoy%	42%	35%	39%	66%	198%	-27%	102%	47%	189%	2%	-5%
EBIT yoy%	158%	68%	62%	137%	405%	-214%	-404%	101%	348%	-5%	-14%
NP yoy%	322%	70%	119%	90%	397%	-509%	-317%	117%	324%	-8%	-11%
CAPEX						(8,780)	(16,663)	(28,579)	(51,662)	(52,915)	(50,140)
FCF						(4,502)	13,133	24,794	139,205	134,083	103,999
ROE						-16%	31%	44%	86%	44%	28%

Source: Company, BNP Paribas Equity Research estimates

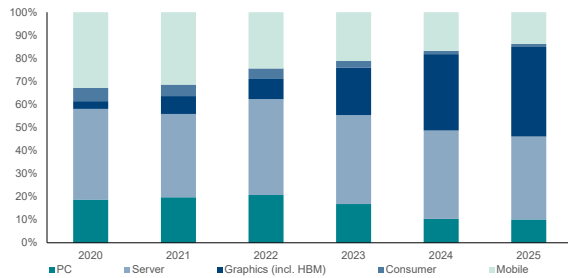
Figure 3: Valuation table

(KRW bn)	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
EPS (KRW)	28,727	61,984	263,260	241,848	216,285
yoy%	-317%	116%	325%	-8%	-11%
BPS (KRW)	107,304	174,218	434,478	667,512	875,699
P/B vs. ROE Method	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
BPS (KRW)	107,304	174,218	434,478	667,512	875,699
ROE (%)	31%	44%	86%	44%	28%
Equity risk premium				5.5%	
Beta				2.0	
Risk free (%)				3.7%	
Cost of equity				14.7%	
Target P/B (x)				3.0	
TP (KRW)				2,000,000	
Implied PB			4.6	3.0	2.3
Implied PE			7.6	8.3	9.2

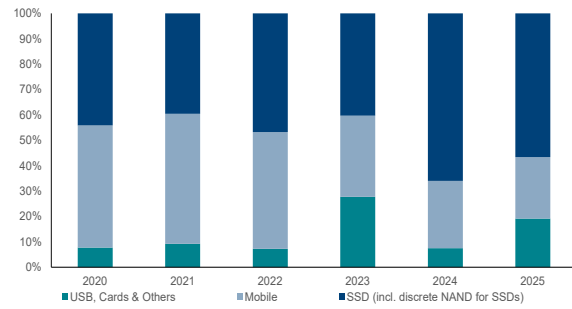
Source: Company, BNP Paribas Equity Research estimates

Figure 4: SK Hynix revenue by application

DRAM revenue breakdown by applications



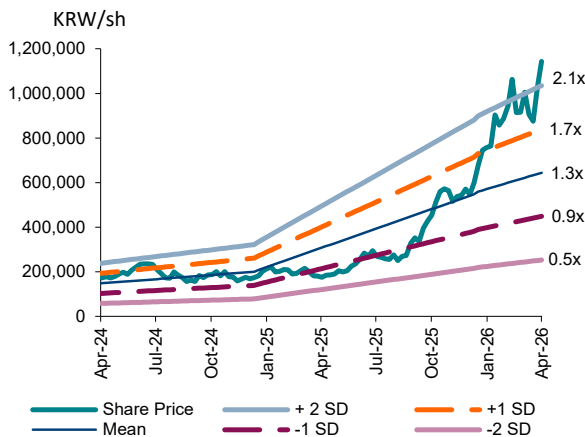
NAND revenue breakdown by end use market



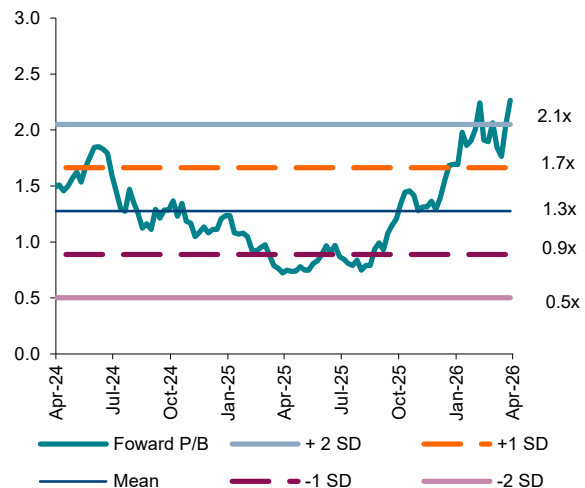
Source: Company, BNP Paribas Equity Research

Figure 5: P/E band charts

Historical NTM P/E Band



Historical NTM P/B vs 2-year average



Source: Bloomberg, BNP Paribas Equity Research estimates

Investment case, valuation and risks

SK Hynix (Outperform, Target Price KRW2,000,000)

Investment case

SK Hynix (SKH) has the highest exposure to AI memory (c70% of revenue) among top memory players. We believe SKH's favourable portfolio and high-end market exposure provides the company with high visibility of profit growth.

We believe SKH's leadership in HBM3E will expand to HBM4 and beyond, with >50% market share, and it will capture the HBM market growth. We estimate 66%/62% y-y HBM demand growth in bit shipments in 2026E/27E.

In addition, by leveraging the cutting-edge tech in NAND fabrication and 3D packaging + a dominant HBM position, we expect SKH to grab >50% share of the HBF market, which could add c60mn TB NAND in 2028, accounting for c20% of SKH's total NAND bit shipments.

Valuation methodology

Our TP is based on a 3x target P/B on 2027E BVPS. We derive our target P/B multiple by applying 2027E ROE of 44%, cost of equity 14.7% (on stock beta of 2.0x, risk-free rate of 3.7% and equity risk premium 5.5%). We have applied a higher 2027E P/B multiple of 3.0x for SKH compared to its historical range of 0.8-2.0x to reflect a fundamental structural shift in its earnings profile.

Risks

To the upside:

1) Upcycle in the memory cyclical fluctuations; 2) less fierce market competition in DRAM and NAND markets; 3) fewer fluctuations in exchange rates; and 4) Fewer tariff restrictions.

To the downside:

1) Downturn in the memory cyclical fluctuations; 2) fiercer market competition in DRAM and NAND markets; 3) more fluctuations in exchange rates; and 4) more tariff restrictions.

ANALYST CERTIFICATION AND IMPORTANT DISCLOSURES

Analyst Certification

We, **Alex Chang, Scarlett GE, Gwen Wang**, hereby certify that all of the views expressed in this report accurately reflect our personal view(s) about the company or companies and securities discussed in this report. No part of our compensation was, is, or will be, directly, or indirectly, related to the specific recommendations or views expressed in this research report.

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/	

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Company/ies	Ticker/s	Relevant Disclosures
Alphabet A	GOOGL US	2; 3; 4; 6; 7; 8- BNP Paribas Securities Corp. is acting as passive bookrunner on a simultaneously EUR/USD bond offering out of Alphabet Inc. NASDAQ:GOOGL as announced to the markets this morning, April 28, 2025. ; 10
ASMPT	522 HK	/
SK Hynix	000660 KS	3; 4; 7; 8; 9; 10; 11- Net long position
TSMC	2330 TT	3; 4; 7; 8; 9; 10; 11- Net long position
TSMC ADR	TSM US	3; 4; 7; 8; 9; 10

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Our coverage analysts use a rating system in which they rate stocks as Outperform, Neutral, or Underperform (as defined below) relative to other companies covered by the analyst or the analyst's team, over a 12-month investment horizon.

Outperform (O/P): The stock is expected to outperform the average total return of all companies covered by the analyst or the analyst's team, over a 12-month investment horizon.

Neutral: The stock is expected to perform in line with the average total return of all companies covered by the analyst or the analyst's team, over a 12-month investment horizon.

Underperform (U/P): The stock is expected to underperform the average total return of all companies covered by the analyst or the analyst's team, over a 12-month investment horizon.

Under review: The rating of the stock has been placed under review after significant news. Any possible change will be confirmed as soon as possible in the form of a new broadly disseminated report.

Restricted (RS): The stock is covered by BNPP but there is no Rating and no Target Price because BNPP is involved in an equity capital market/ merger and acquisition transaction relating to the subject company.

Not Rated (NR): The stock is covered by BNPP but there is no Rating and no Target Price at this time.

Not Covered (NC): BNPP does not cover this company

As of 23 September 2024, TEB Investment has changed the recommendation rating structure for Turkish stock coverage from Buy, Hold and Reduce to Outperform, Neutral and Underperform. Ratings and target prices for dates prior to 23 September 2024 used an absolute rating structure whereby the upside or downside to target price relative to the current share price determined the recommendation. TEB Investment now uses a relative recommendation structure whereby the applied rating is based on the stock's expected performance as compared to the average total return of all companies covered by the analyst or the analyst's team in Turkish stock coverage over a 12-month investment horizon. TEB Investment research reports with ratings and target prices for dates prior to 11 August 2025 were prepared and distributed without involvement of a FINRA member firm.

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ESG integration methodology: The BNP Paribas approach offers an alternative to mechanistic ESG scores and leverages the in-depth knowledge of our industry equity research teams by combining quantitative and qualitative factors. There are three steps to our framework; firstly, our teams build a materiality map to assess which ESG topics are most relevant to their respective industries. Secondly, for the chosen topics, companies are assessed relative to sector peers. The assessment can be based on metrics and qualitative judgements. Each company is given a one to five score per topic, with five being the best. Thirdly, based on the topic scores, and any other significant ESG factors, we identify companies in the sector as ESG Leaders, ESG Laggards or ESG Average. The definition of the ratings is shown below; they are not based on the average topic score as some topic scores can be more material than others.

ESG Leader: Relative to sector peers an ESG Leader is better positioned on the chosen ESG topics, or other relevant ESG considerations.

ESG Average: A company rated as ESG Average may have strong or poor performance on an individual ESG topic, but overall has an average exposure to ESG risks and opportunities.

ESG Laggard: Relative to sector peers an ESG Laggard is poorly positioned on the chosen ESG topics, or other relevant ESG considerations for the stock.

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Ratings	Stocks coverage		Investment Banking Services Within the previous 12 months	
	Counts	%*	Counts	%
Outperform (Buy)	645	51	166	26
Neutral (Hold)	428	34	101	24
Underperform (Sell)	202	16	42	21

* Please note that the percentages might not add up to 100% because of rounding.

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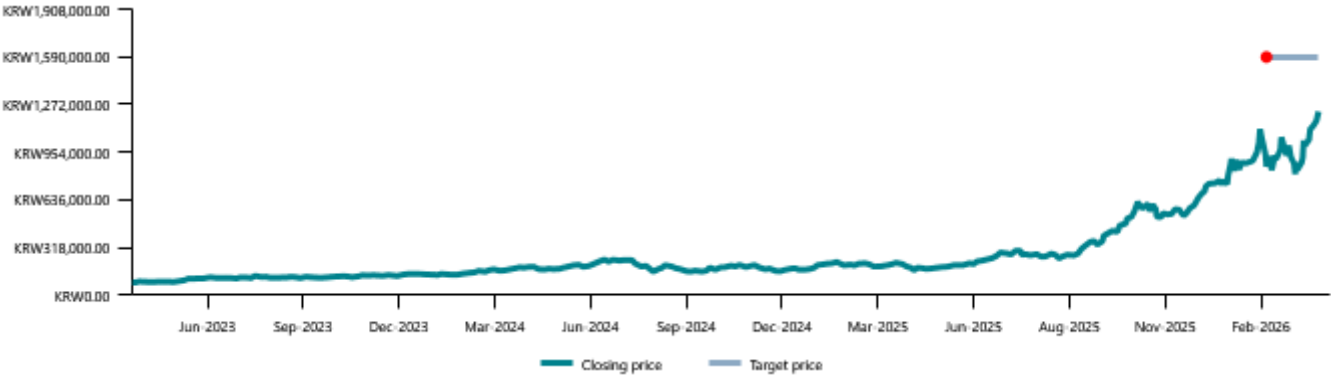
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Price and Ratings Chart

SK Hynix

Historical Closing Price & Target Price (closing price as of 22/04/2026)



Source: BNP Paribas

Historical rating & target price changes

Date & Time of Dissemination (London time) (2)	Rating (1)	Target Price	Closing Price	Key Changes	Person(s) Involved
23 Apr 2026 (2)	+	KRW2000000.00	KRW1226000.00	TP up	A. Chang, S. GE, G. Wang
4 Mar. 2026 08:59	+	KRW1590000.00	KRW941000.00	Initiation of coverage	A. Chang, S. GE, G. Wang

- (1) With effect from 23 September 2024, BNP Paribas changed its research rating system - please refer to the 'Explanation of Research Ratings'.
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